

Under threat

All around the world, animals are in decline and many species are facing extinction. As the human population grows bigger—using more space, eating more food, and polluting the environment—it becomes harder for animals to survive.

Biodiversity hot spots

Some places on Earth are especially rich in plant and animal species. These biodiversity hot spots are highly vulnerable to threats such as deforestation and climate change because many of the species that live there are found nowhere else in the world. This map shows some of the world's most important hot spots, on land and in the sea.



Amazon rainforest

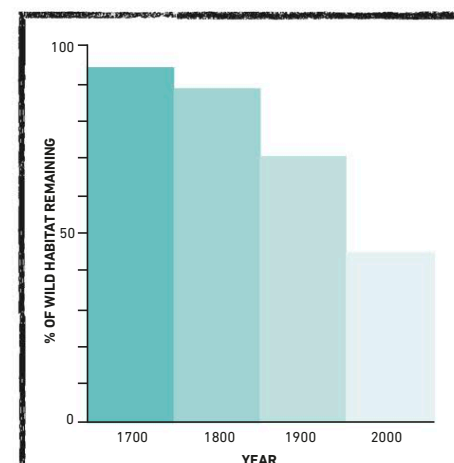
The Amazon rainforest is a biodiversity hot spot containing thousands of species of insects, birds, and other animals, in a huge variety of different habitats. However, this spectacular South American region is under threat, mainly from the farming industry, which is clearing land for grazing cattle and to grow animal feed.

Rich habitat

The bright, airy canopy of the rainforest is so different from the dense vegetation growing underneath, they are like two separate habitats—with different species of animals living in each.

Many species

The Amazon rainforest is teeming with countless different creatures, from jaguars, anteaters, and colorful birds to tiny insects and not-so-tiny spiders. Many of the plant and animal species in this rich habitat rely on other species for things like food, shelter, and protection.



Declining wilderness

Since the Industrial Revolution, when humans started burning more fuel for energy and clearing habitats on a scale greater than ever before, wild animals have lost more than 50 percent of their living space. The wilderness has been converted to cities, farms, roads, and other developments.